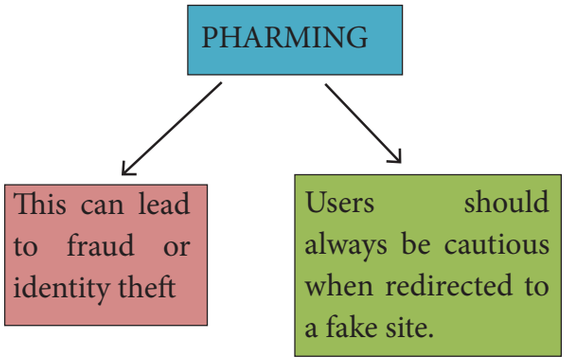

Figure 17.5 Diagrammatic representation of Pharming

Man In The Middle (MITM)

Man-in-the-middle attack (MITM; also Janus attack) is an attack where the attacker secretly relays and possibly alters the communication between two parties who believe they are directly communicating with each other.

Example: Suppose Alice wishes to communicate with Bob. Meanwhile, Mallory wishes to intercept the conversation to overhear and optionally to deliver a false message to Bob.

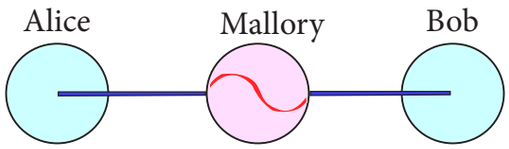

Figure 17.6 - An illustration of the Man-In-The-Middle attack

Cookies

A cookie (also called HTTP cookie, web cookie, Internet cookie, browser cookie, or simply cookie) is a small piece of data sent from a website and stored on the user's computer memory (Hard drive) by the user's web browser while the user is browsing internet. Cookies were designed to be a reliable mechanism for websites to remember stateful information (such as items added in the shopping cart in an online store) or to record the user's browsing activity (including clicking particular buttons, logging in etc.). They can also be used to remember arbitrary pieces of information that the user previously entered into form fields such as names, addresses, passwords, and credit card numbers. From the security point of view, if cookie data is not encrypted, any anonymous user (hacker) can access the cookie information and misuse it.

Web sites typically use cookies for the following reasons:

- To collect demographic information about who has visited the Web site.
- Sites often use this information to track how often visitors come to the site and how long they remain on the site.
- It helps to personalize the user's experience on the Web site.
- Cookies can help store personal information about users so that when a usersubsequently returns to the site, a more personalized experience is provided.

Chapter 17 Page 275-285.indd 281 3/24/2020 9:24:13 AM